

Sample Deparsing

```
control MyDeparser(packet_out packet,
                   in my_headers_t hdr)
{
    apply {
        /* Layer 2 */
        packet.emit(hdr.ethernet);
        packet.emit(hdr.vlan_tag);

        /* Layer 2.5 */
        packet.emit(hdr.mpls);

        /* Layer 3 */
        /* ARP */
        packet.emit(hdr.arp);
        packet.emit(hdr.arp_ipv4);
        /* IPv4 */
        packet.emit(hdr.ipv4);
        /* IPv6 */
        packet.emit(hdr.ipv6);

        /* Layer 4 */
        packet.emit(hdr.icmp);
        packet.emit(hdr.tcp);
        packet.emit(hdr.udp);
    }
}
```

- **Assembling the packet from headers**
- **Expressed as another control function**
 - No need for another construct
- **packet_out – defined in core.p4**
 - emit(header) – serialize the header **if** it is valid
 - emit(header_stack) – serialize the valid elements in order
- **Advantages over p4_14:**
 - Decoupling of parsing and deparsing

Agenda

- Why Dataplan Programming
- P4 Overview
- Main Data Types
- Packet Parsing
- Packet Processing
- Packet Deparsing
- Program Structure
- P4 Runtime
- Summary

Overall P4 Program Structure

```

/* -*- P4_16 -*- */
#include <core.p4>
#include <v1model.p4>

/***** TYPES *****/
typedef bit<48> mac_addr_t;
header ethernet_t { /* Slide 30 */
struct my_headers_t { /* Slide 30 */

/***** CONSTANTS *****/
const mac_addr_t BROADCAST_MAC = 0xFFFFFFFF;

/***** PARSERS and CONTROLS *****/
parser MyParser(...) { /* Slide 38 */
control MyVerifyChecksum(...) { /* Slide 76 */
control MyIngress(...) { /* Slide 44 */
control MyEgress(...) {
control MyComputeChecksum(...) { /* Slide 76 */
control MyDeparser(...) { /* Slide 65 */

/***** FULL PACKAGE *****/
V1Switch(
    MyParser(), MyVerifyChecksum(), MyIngress(),
    MyEgress(), MyComputeChecksum(), MyDeparser()
) main;

```

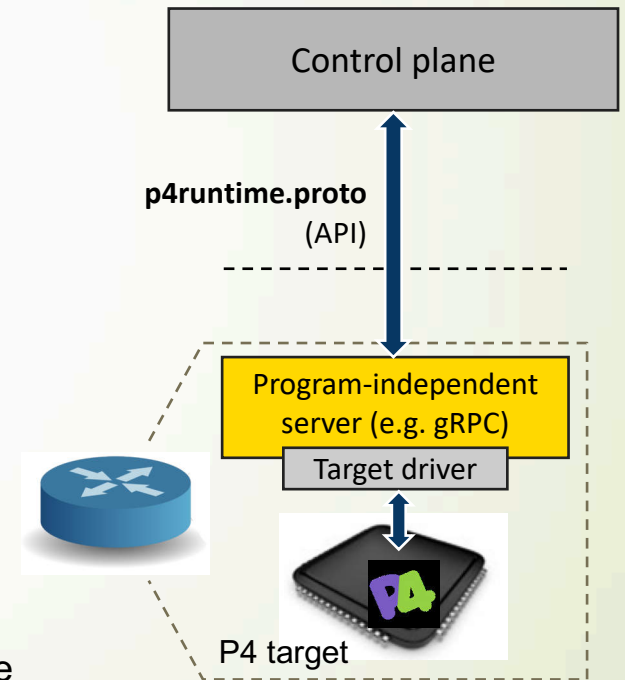
- Start with Emacs-style comment to select the proper editor mode
- Include the core library
- Include the architecture-specific file(s)
- Define Types
 - typedefs, headers, structs, ...
- Define Constants
- Define Parsers and Controls
- Assemble the top-level controls in a package
 - Package is defined by the Architecture
 - Represents the set of programmable P4 components and their interfaces
 - The name of the package must be **main**
- That's it!

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What is P4Runtime?

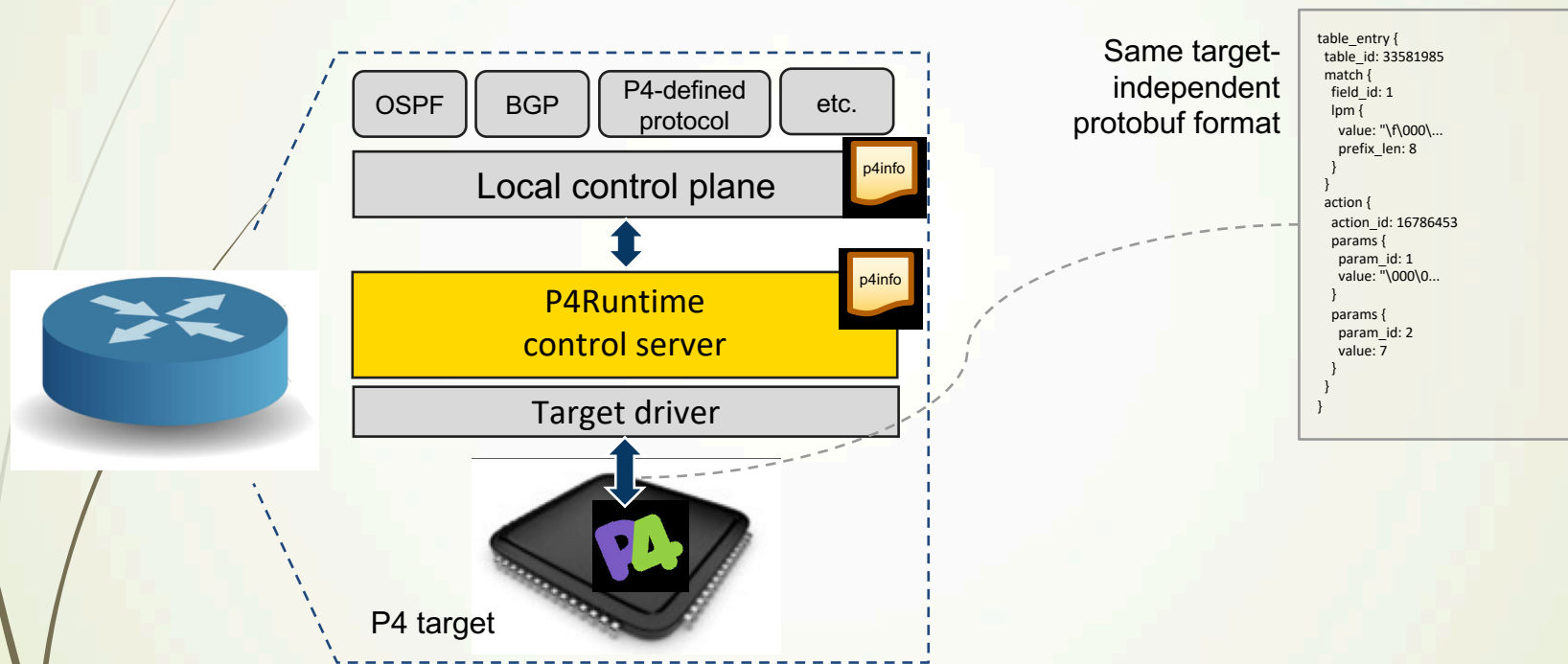
- **Framework for runtime control of P4 targets**
 - Open-source API + server implementation
 - <https://github.com/p4lang/PI>
 - Initial contribution by Google and Barefoot
- **Work-in-progress by the p4.org API WG**
 - Draft of version 1.0 available
- **Protobuf-based API definition**
 - p4runtime.proto
 - gRPC transport
- **P4 program-independent**
 - API doesn't change with the P4 program
- **Enables field-reconfigurability**
 - Ability to push new P4 program without recompiling the software stack of target switches



Properties of Runtime Control APIs

API	Target-independent	Protocol-independent
P4 compiler auto-generated		X
BMv2 CLI	X	
OpenFlow		X
SAI		X
P4Runtime		

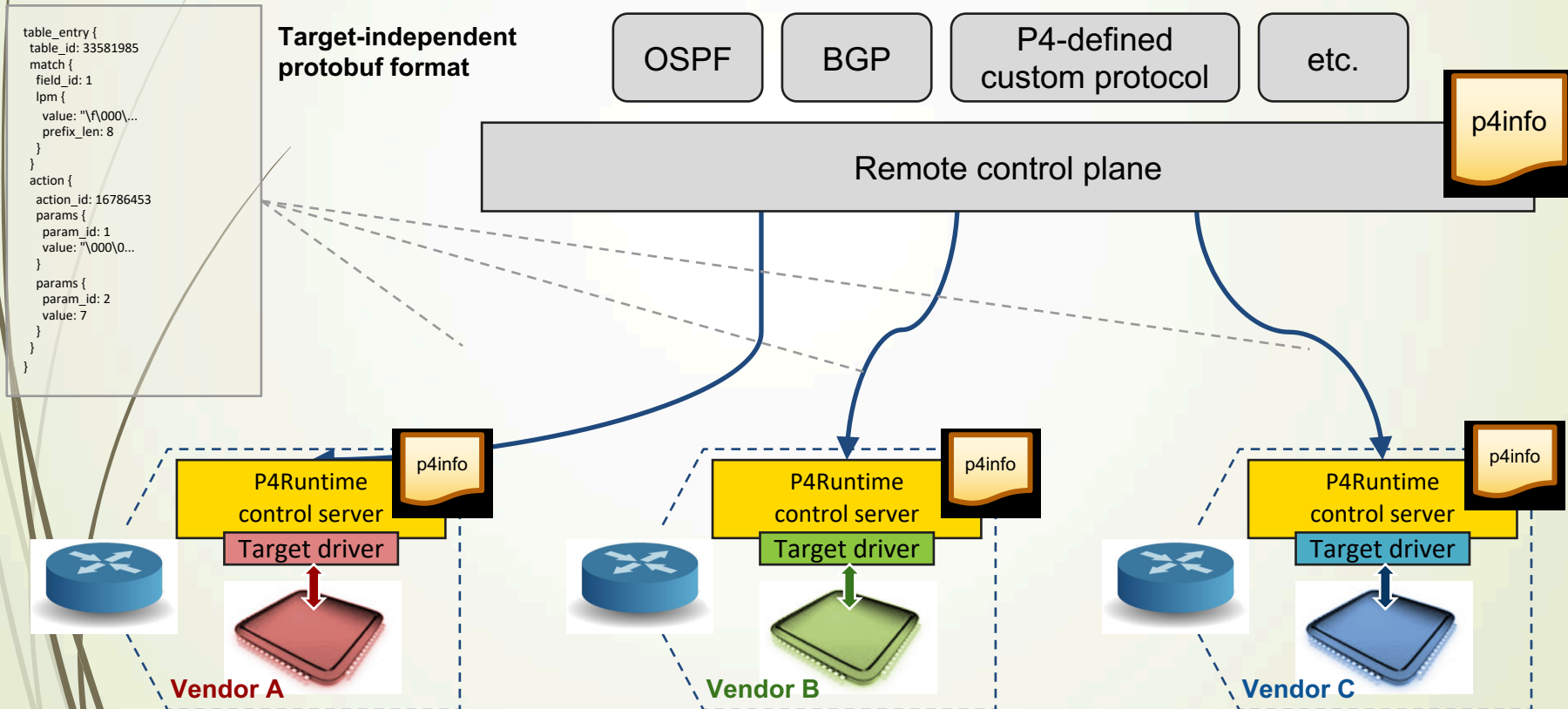
Local Control Plane



P4Runtime can be used equally well
by a remote or local control plane

Remote Control Plane

Sample Controller: ONOS



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Advantages of P4₁₆

- **Clearly defined semantics**
 - You can describe what your data plane program is doing
- **Expressive**
 - Supports a wide range of architectures through standard methodology
- **High-level, Target-independent**
 - Uses conventional constructs
 - Compiler manages the resources and deals with the hardware
- **Type-safe**
 - Enforces good software design practices and eliminates “stupid” bugs
- **Agility**
 - High-speed networking devices become as flexible as any software
- **Insight**
 - Freely mixing packet headers and intermediate results

**We couldn't cover everything, please see
tutorials and presentations at p4.org**

Questions

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